

MIRROR IMAGE - Comprehensive Rules

100. General

100.1. These rules govern play of *Mirror Image*. If a card's text conflicts with these rules, follow the card.

100.2. Each non-resource card is an **Asset** with base type **Entity** or **Cyberspell**. If a card does not list Cyberspell as a supertype, its base type is Entity.

100.3. Whenever card text uses the word "this," it refers to the card that printed that text.

100.4. A player wins the game only when a Hold score makes that player's  greater than or equal to the victory number printed on that player's pilot (see rules 250.7.2 and 400.2.2.4).

100.4.1. Each pilot has its own victory number.

100.4.2. The  that causes a player to reach or exceed their victory number can be gained only by Hold, at the start of that player's turn. Conquer and any other  gain cannot cause a win. If a gain other than Hold would meet or exceed that player's victory number, that player gains  only until they are one below it.

100.5. Players score  by controlling **objectives**: Conquer when you gain control of one, and Hold at the start of your turn (see section 250).

100.6.  (**Threat Level**). Only cards with the Unit supertype have a  on the card.

*100.6.1. **Split format** **[dmg|hp]** . When printed as two numbers separated by a vertical bar (for example, **3|2**), the first number is the unit's **damage value** and the second is its **health value**.*

*100.6.2. **Combined format** **[dmg+hp]** . When printed as a single number (for example, **3**), that number is both the unit's damage value and its health value.*

*100.6.3. In these rules, a unit's **damage value** is the damage it deals in combat; its **health value** is how much marked damage it can take before it is defeated. Effects that modify  modify the corresponding value unless stated otherwise.*

100.7. Multiple supertypes and subtypes

100.7. A card may have multiple supertypes and subtypes. It has all applicable rules from each type printed on it.

100.7.1. If two type rules conflict, the more permissive rule applies unless card text says otherwise (see rule 100.1).

100.7.2. A card with the Unit supertype may attack even if another of its types would prevent attacking.

100.7.3. An attack is declared at an objective (see section 602).

100.8. Targeting

100.8.1. Some effects use the word "target." Those effects require one or more legal targets to be chosen.

100.8.2. A target is legal only if it meets **every** restriction printed on that effect (type, controller, zone, game state, and so on).

100.8.3. If an effect names a supertype or subtype (for example, "Technology"), the target must have that type. A card with multiple types has all of them (see rule 100.7).

100.8.4. If an effect uses an exclusion (for example, "non-Unit"), the target is illegal if it has the excluded supertype or subtype, even if it also satisfies a required type.

100.8.5. You cannot choose an illegal target. If a card or ability requires targets and no legal targets exist, you cannot play that card or activate that ability.

100.8.6. Declare targets when the effect enters the lock or a queue (see rules 500.4 and 800.2.3).

100.8.7. If every target of a targeted effect is illegal when that effect resolves, the effect does nothing to those targets.

100.8.8. Keywords and other rules may further restrict or modify targeting and what can happen to a chosen target (see section 800.3).

100.8.9. Combat damage assignment follows the attack's damage step (see rule 602.7).

100.8.10. If an effect does not specify a zone, only cards and objects on the battlefield may be chosen (see rule 200.3). Units on an objective are on the battlefield. To target a card in the stockpile, hand, discard pile, dismantle pile, pilot zone, or another zone, the effect must say so.

200. Zones

200.1. **Pilot zone:** Holds your pilot. You may play your pilot from here by paying its invoke cost. When your pilot is defeated or would change zones, you may return it here and increase its cost by  2 for the rest of the game.

200.2. **Deck:** Your face-down shuffled deck of entity and cyberspell cards.

200.3. **Battlefield:** Where played entities go unless time counters were used (see rule 700.4). Units on an objective are on the battlefield (see rule 200.11).

200.4. **Stockpile:** Where readied resources are stored and where time-counter cards wait. **Expend** a resource (turn it 90° horizontal) to add its color to your resource pool.

200.5. **In play:** Battlefield and stockpile together. Effects on "in play" affect both unless specified.

200.6. **Discard pile:** Where defeated units, resolved cyberspells, and trashed cards go.

200.7. **Dismantle pile:** Removed-from-game pile. Cards in the dismantle pile are always face up. When you would gain a resource token, you may take one from the dismantle pile instead.

200.8. **Resource pool:** Imaginary zone where expended resources go until end of turn; spend pool resources to pay invoke costs.

200.9. **Lock:** Holds at most one card or effect before it resolves (see section 700).

200.10. **Queue:** Holds overflow effects while the lock is full (see rule 700.3).

200.11. **Objective:** Shared area of the **battlefield** for **objective cards** and the units on them. Units on an objective are on the battlefield. You still control those units. They ready as entities you control (see rule 400.2.2.1). Units on an objective skip the start-of-turn heal step (see rule 400.2.2.2).

250. Objectives

250.1. This game is for 2–4 players. Objectives are **objective cards** brought with each player's deck and placed during setup (see rules 250.8 and 400.1.6).

250.2. An objective is empty, or has **any number of units** on it (a stack). Units of more than one player may be on the same objective.

250.3. The **pilot is a unit**. It may be on an objective and counts toward controlling that objective.

250.4. Programs, technologies, and resources cannot be on an objective unless they are also a unit.

250.5. If a unit leaves play or otherwise leaves an objective, it is no longer on that objective. Other units on that objective stay. Control is determined only by which players have units on the objective (see rule 250.6).

250.6. You **control** an objective if you have at least one unit on it and no opponent does. Otherwise you do not control it.

250.7. Scoring

250.7.1. **Conquer.** When you gain control of an objective, gain 1 . Conquer cannot award the winning  (see rule 100.4.2).

250.7.1.1. You gain control when you have at least one unit on it and no opponent does, and you did not already control it.

*250.7.1.2. Moving onto an **empty** objective does not cause Conquer.*

250.7.1.3. Reinforcing an objective you already control does not cause Conquer.

250.7.1.4. Entering an objective another player still occupies does not cause Conquer until you are the only player with a unit on it.

250.7.2. **Hold.** At the start of your turn, after start-of-turn abilities resolve (see rule 400.2.2.4), gain 1  per objective you control. Then check win (see rule 100.4). This is the only  gain that can win the game (see rule 100.4.2). Objectives you do not control score 0.

250.8. Objective cards

250.8.1. An **objective card** is neither an entity nor a cyberspell. It is separate from your 40-card deck and is not shuffled into your deck (see rule 900.2.6).

250.8.2. Each objective card has its own rules text. While you **control** that objective (see rule 250.6), you get the benefit of that card's rules text. While you do not control it, you do not get that benefit.

250.8.2.1. If an objective's text conflicts with these rules, follow the card (see rule 100.1).

250.8.2.2. An objective's text may grant abilities, modify combat on that objective, change scoring, or other effects as printed. Follow the printed timing and restrictions.

250.8.3. Objective cards in play sit in the shared objective area of the battlefield (see rule 200.11). Units on an objective are on the battlefield.

250.8.4. **Setup: choosing and placing.** After first player is determined (see rule 400.1.3), starting with the first player and proceeding clockwise, each player chooses one of the three objective cards they brought and places it face up in the shared objective area. Place all chosen objectives this way before the game begins.

250.8.4.1. A player's unchosen objective cards are set aside out of the game for this game.

250.8.4.2. The number of objectives in play equals the number of players (each player places one).

250.8.4.3. See rule 400.1.6 for when this step happens in setup order.

300. Card Types

300.1. Base types

300.1.1. **Cyberspell**: After resolving (or being overwritten), goes to the discard pile.

300.1.2. **Entity**: After resolving, goes to the battlefield unless played with time counters (then stockpile). If overwritten, goes to the discard pile.

300.1.3. Playing any entity or cyberspell card puts it in the lock unless time counters replace that step (see rules 500 and 700.4). Tokens are not played this way (see rule 300.2.7).

300.1.4. A card may list more than one supertype or subtype. When type rules overlap or conflict, apply rule 100.7.

300.2. Supertypes

300.2.1. **Pilot [Entity]**: Starts in the pilot zone; a unit you may play from there. The pilot may be on an objective and counts toward controlling it (see rule 250.3).

300.2.2. **Unit [Entity]**: Call-in combatants (see rule 100.6). After resolving, enter the battlefield unless time was used (see rule 700.4). When a unit you control enters the battlefield, it enters **readied**.

300.2.2.1. A unit cannot attack during the turn it entered the battlefield unless it has **Blitz** (see rule 800.3.3). Moving onto an opponent-controlled objective is an attack (see rule 605.4), so a unit that entered this turn cannot do that unless it has **Blitz**.

300.2.2.2. A unit that entered the battlefield this turn **may** move onto an empty objective or an objective you **control** (see rules 605.2 and 605.3).

300.2.2.3. If a unit enters the battlefield because the last time counter was removed from it (see rule 700.4.4), its controller chooses whether it enters readied or expended, and it gains **Blitz** until the end of the turn (see rule 800.3.3).

300.2.3. **Program [Entity]**: Stays in play; cannot attack.

300.2.4. **Technology [Entity]**: Support or counter-play; cannot attack.

300.2.5. **Prototype [Any]**: Limited to one copy per deck.

300.2.6. **Resource [Entity]**: Tokens gained readied into stockpile; usable immediately.

300.2.7. **Token [Entity]:** Usually created by an effect, not played from hand or other zones.

300.2.7.1. Tokens do not go to the discard pile when defeated or trashed.

300.2.7.2. You may use your own objects as tokens if it is clear which token they represent and whether they are expended.

300.2.7.3. You cannot use non-token MIRROR IMAGE cards as tokens.

300.2.7.4. When an effect creates a token, that creation may enter the lock if it is empty, or its controller's queue if the lock is full (see section 700).

300.2.7.5. The token is not created until the creating effect resolves.

300.2.7.6. When a resource token is created, put it into the stockpile readied (see rule 300.2.6).

300.2.7.7. When any other token is created, put it onto the battlefield. If it is a unit, it enters readied (see rule 300.2.2); otherwise it enters readied.

300.3. Subtypes

300.3.1. **Process [Cyberspell]:** Playable during your main phase while the lock is empty. See rule 500.8 for full timing.

300.3.2. **Quick Hack [Cyberspell]:** Playable whenever a Process can be played, plus at end of turn, during an attack, while the lock holds a card, or when an opponent's effect empties the lock. See rule 500.8 for full timing.

350. Resource Pips and Invoke Costs

350.1. A card's **invoke cost** is the row of symbols in its upper-left corner. Each symbol in an invoke cost is a **resource pip** (or pip).

350.2. To play a card, pay every pip in its invoke cost from your resource pool unless an effect says otherwise (see section 500). A card with no invoke cost in the upper-left corner cannot be played unless an effect allows it. By default, cards are played from hand (see rule 500.2.1).

350.3. Colored pips

350.3.1. **Solid colored pips** represent one resource of that color. The colored pip types are life , metal , power , RAM , time , and steel .

350.3.2. **Hybrid pips** show two colors on one symbol (for example ) Pay one resource that matches either color shown.

350.3.3. Colored pips may be gained when you accumulate resources (see rule 601.1).

350.4. Generic pips

350.4.1. **Generic pips** are grey numbered symbols such as , , and other numbered generic values through , plus  and  where printed.

350.4.2. Each generic pip may be paid with one resource of **any** color from your pool (see rule 500.6).

350.4.3. Generic pips are not colored pips. They are ignored when accumulating resources (see rule 601.1).

350.4.4. Time counters may reduce generic pip costs only (see rule 700.4).

400. Setup and Turns

400.1. Setup

400.1.1. This game is for 2–4 players. Each player needs a pilot, a deck, three objective cards,  tracking, damage dice, time-counter dice, and resource tokens.

400.1.2. Place pilot in the pilot zone; shuffle your deck; place pilot's starting resources readied in stockpile; draw a starting hand as printed on your pilot. Each player starts at 0 . Your victory number is the  printed on your pilot. Keep your three objective cards face down beside your deck until they are chosen (see rule 400.1.6).

400.1.3. Determine first player randomly; that player chooses whether to go first. Turn order is clockwise from the first player.

400.1.4. Each player may mulligan once (first player mulligans first): put any number of hand cards on the bottom of the deck, then draw that many. Your maximum hand size is the hand size printed on your pilot.

400.1.5. The player who takes the first turn chooses two resources in their stockpile and s them (turn them 90° horizontal). If that player controls fewer than two resources in their stockpile, they expend all of them. Those resources remain expended during that player's first start-of-turn ready step (see rule 400.2.2.1); they ready normally on later turns. That player also skips the draw phase on their first turn (see rule 400.2.3.2).

400.1.6. **Place objectives.** After first player is known (rule 400.1.3), starting with the first player and proceeding clockwise, each player chooses one of their three objective cards and places it face up in the shared objective area (see rule 250.8.4). Set aside each player's unchosen objectives out of the game.

400.2. Turn structure

400.2.1. Each turn has 4 phases in order: start of turn, draw, main, end-of-turn.

400.2.2. Start of turn

400.2.2.1. Ready all entities you control.

400.2.2.2. **Heal.** Remove 1 marked damage (not below 0) from each unit you control on the battlefield that is **not** on an objective. Units on an objective skip this step. Opponent units do not heal on your turn.

400.2.2.3. Trigger all abilities with the start-of-turn tag.

400.2.2.4. **Hold** . Gain 1  for each objective you control. Then check win (see rule 100.4). This is the only  gain that can win the game (see rule 100.4.2). Objectives you do not control score 0.

400.2.2.5. Remove one time counter from each card you control in play; resolve effects when the last counter is removed from a stockpile card.

400.2.3. Draw phase

400.2.3.1. Draw one card.

400.2.3.2. **Exception: first turn.** The player who takes the first turn of the game skips this phase on that turn. That player draws normally on later turns.

400.2.4. Main phase

400.2.4.1. You may play cards, activate abilities, make attacks, move units onto or off objectives, or accumulate resources, in any order where timing allows.

400.2.4.2. See sections 600–605 for default game actions.

400.2.5. End-of-turn phase

400.2.5.1. Players may play Quick Hacks or activate abilities, active player first, until both pass.

400.2.5.2. Trigger end-of-turn abilities.

400.2.5.3. Lose unspent resources in your resource pool (not stockpile).

400.2.5.4. **Discard to hand size.** This is the last step of the end-of-turn phase. The active player discards cards from their hand until the number of cards in their hand equals the hand size printed on their pilot. If their hand is already at or below that number, they discard nothing.

500. Playing Cards

500.1. Each playable card has an invoke cost made of resource pips (see section 350) in the upper-left corner.

500.2. To play a card, have the required resources in your resource pool, pay the cost, reveal the card, and put it in the lock. If the lock is empty, the card becomes the lock occupant. If the lock is full, only a Quick Hack played by the active player may enter the lock; it overwrites the lock occupant (see rules 500.8.3, 700.2.3, and 700.2.4). Only effects go to a queue when the lock is full (see rule 700.2.2).

500.2.1. **Where you may play from.** By default, you play cards from your hand. You may play a card from another zone only if a card ability or effect explicitly allows it: for example, from your pilot zone, discard pile, or dismantle pile. Such a play still follows rules 500.3–500.5 and 700.4 unless the ability says otherwise.

500.3. If the card targets, you must have legal targets before playing it (see section 100.8).

500.4. When the card enters the lock, declare targets and resolve **INVOKE** tags immediately. The card remains the lock occupant until it resolves or is overwritten by another played card.

500.4.1. While it is the lock occupant, the active player may overwrite it with a Quick Hack or take other actions allowed while the lock is full (see section 700).

500.5. If the lock occupant is not overwritten, it resolves when the lock process allows: put the card in its zone (battlefield for entities, discard pile for cyberspells), resolve its **EFFECT** tag, then other triggers such as **ENTERS**.

500.6. Generic pips may be paid with any one pool resource each; time counters may reduce generic pip costs (see rules 350.4 and 700.4).

500.7. Resource tokens usually have  abilities that add one or two resources of their color to your pool.

500.7.1. Using a resource's  ability does not use the lock; expend the resource and add its color to your resource pool immediately.

500.7.2. *You may use resource abilities while the lock is full (see rule 700.5.1).*

500.8. When you may play cards

500.8.1. **Process speed:** You may play a Process cyberspell during your main phase on your turn while the lock is empty (see rule 300.3.1). You may play an entity from your hand during your main phase on your turn while the lock is empty unless an effect gives another timing. Playing your pilot from the pilot zone follows rule 200.1.

500.8.2. **Quick Hack speed:** A Quick Hack cyberspell may be played whenever you could play a Process, and also (see rule 300.3.2):

500.8.2.1. *During the end-of-turn phase (see rule 400.2.5.1).*

500.8.2.2. *During an attack response window (see rule 602.5).*

500.8.2.3. *While the lock holds a card: only the active player, and only by overwriting the lock occupant (see rules 700.2.3 and 700.3.6).*

500.8.2.4. *When an opponent's effect empties the lock.*

500.8.3. **While the lock is full:** You cannot play a Process or entity while the lock is full. The only card you may play while the lock is full is a Quick Hack, and only if you are the active player and you overwrite the lock occupant (see section 700).

500.8.4. **Quick Hack timing elsewhere:** Activated abilities, Recycle, Surge, and other effects that use Quick Hack timing follow the windows in rule 500.8.2 unless stated otherwise (see rules 800.2.1, 800.2.5, and 800.3.20).

600. Default Game Actions

601. Accumulate resources

601.1. Once per turn during your main phase, reveal a card from hand and gain up to two resource tokens from its colored pips (ignore generic pips; see section 350).

601.2. Put gained resources readied into stockpile; put the revealed card on the bottom of your deck.

601.2.1. *If you gained one or fewer resources this way, draw a card.*

601.3. This action does not use the lock.

601.4. Resource tokens created this way are created immediately in the stockpile; they do not use the lock-and-resolve flow in rule 300.2.7.

602. Attack

602.1. To attack, declare an attack at an objective. Marked damage on units persists until healed (see rule 400.2.2.2).

602.2. **Declare attackers:** Choose unit(s) you control that are legal attackers: units on the battlefield (including units already on that objective). Multiple attackers are one attack. A unit may attack if it has the Unit supertype, including when it also has a type that otherwise cannot attack (see rules 100.7 and 100.7.2).

602.2.1. A card with one or more time counters on it cannot attack (see rule 700.4.2.1). When the last counter is removed from a stockpile card, it moves to the battlefield and, if it is a unit, gains Blitz until the end of the turn (see rules 700.4.4 and 300.2.2.3).

602.2.2. A unit cannot attack during the turn it entered the battlefield under your control unless it has Blitz (see rules 300.2.2.1 and 800.3.3).

602.2.3. You cannot declare an attack at an objective that has no opposing unit on it.

602.2.4. If the attackers are not already on that objective, they move onto it as they attack (see rule 605.4). Units already on it still expend to attack as in this section.

602.2.5. Combat is pairwise: the attacker versus the controller of the defending units in that fight. Other players with units on the same objective are not in that combat unless a card targets them.

602.3. **Declare the objective:** Expend unit attackers. Trigger **ATTACK** tags and other on-attack abilities. Damage recipients are chosen in the damage step (see rule 602.7).

602.3.1. **Airborne.** If the defending player has at least one Airborne unit on that objective, the attack is legal only if at least one attacking unit has Airborne or Long Range (see rules 800.3.2 and 800.3.12). That one unit enables the entire attack force.

602.3.2. **Stealth.** If the defending player has at least one unit with Stealth on that objective, pay Stealth as an additional cost of the attack (see rules 800.3.18 and 602.4). Pay **once** for the entire attack force. If more than one such unit is on that objective, pay the highest Stealth X among them.

602.3.3. Other additional costs that would be paid to attack or target a unit on that objective are paid once for the entire attack force, using the highest value among those units if more than one applies.

602.4. **Attack step:** Attackers are now attacking. Pay additional costs as required by rule 602.3.

602.5. **Response window:** Players play Quick Hacks or activate abilities, active player first, until both pass.

602.6. **Preemptive Strike damage:** Attackers with Preemptive Strike deal damage equal to their damage value (including modifiers). The attacking player divides that damage among the defending player's units on that objective, as they choose (rule 602.7.4 still applies). If Preemptive Strike damage was dealt for a unit, that unit skips ordinary combat damage in rule 602.7.

602.7. **Combat damage:** Combat damage is simultaneous, using each unit's damage value from  (including modifiers).

602.7.1. The **attacking player** divides each attacking unit's combat damage among the defending player's units on that objective. Each attacking unit assigns separately. You cannot assign an attacking unit's damage to an Airborne unit unless that attacking unit has Airborne or Long Range. When you have excess damage to assign, assign damage to readied defenders before expended defenders.

602.7.2. The **defending player** divides combat damage from their units on that objective among the attacking units, as they choose. A readied defending unit deals its damage value; an expended defending unit deals 0.

602.7.3. A player may assign all of a unit's damage to one opposing unit, or split it among more than one. Assign all of that unit's damage.

602.7.4. You cannot assign damage from an attacking unit to an Airborne unit unless that attacking unit has Airborne or Long Range.

602.7.5. After damage, a unit is defeated if marked damage $\geq$ its health value (or health value + X with Durable X). Trigger on-defeat abilities; put defeated units in the discard pile.

602.7.6. If combat causes a player to **gain control** of the objective, apply rule 250.7.1 (Conquer).

602.8. After the attack resolves:

602.8.1. If at least one defending unit **and** at least one attacking unit both survived, the attacking units **leave the objective** and remain on their controller's battlefield **expended**. Other units on that objective stay.

602.8.2. If no defending unit survived, every unit that is still in play **stays on that objective**, including surviving attackers (they remain expended).

604. Play a card

604.1. Playing a card is a default game action.

604.2. Which cards you may play, and when, depend on card type, phase, and lock state (see rule 500.8).

604.3. See section 500 for invoke costs, zones you may play from, targeting, and lock interaction.

605. Move onto or off an objective

605.1. During your main phase, as a default game action: choose an objective and a unit(s) you control on the battlefield that is not on an objective and is not waiting on a time counter (this includes your pilot). Move that unit onto the objective.

605.2. **Claim (empty objective)**. Move the unit onto the objective. It keeps its current readied or expended state and does not expend for this move. A unit that entered the battlefield this turn may claim an empty objective (see rule 300.2.2.2). You control the objective after this move (see rule 250.6). Claiming an empty objective does not cause Conquer (see rule 250.7.1.2).

605.3. **Reinforce (you control it)**. Move the unit onto the objective. It keeps its current readied or expended state and does not expend for this move. A unit that entered the battlefield this turn may reinforce (see rule 300.2.2.2). Reinforcing does not cause Conquer (see rule 250.7.1.3).

605.4. **Attack move (opponent controls it)**. This move declares an **attack** with that unit (see section 602). Expend the unit as it joins the stack (if it was already expended, it stays expended). Because this is an attack, **ATTACK**

tags and other attack triggers resolve, and players may play Quick Hacks in the attack response window (see rules 500.8.2.2 and 602.5).

605.4.1. The unit must be a legal attacker (see rules 602.2, 602.2.2, and 300.2.2.1).

605.5. If a move onto an objective causes you to **gain control**, apply rule 250.7.1 (Conquer).

605.6. **Leave**. During your main phase, choose a **readied** unit you control on an objective.  it and move it off the objective; it remains on the battlefield. If this causes a player to gain control, apply Conquer (rule 250.7.1).

605.6.1. You may leave with more than one unit in the same action; expend each chosen unit.

605.6.2. An expended unit on an objective cannot leave this way.

700. The Lock and Time Counters

700.1. Lock overview

700.1.1. The lock holds at most one card or effect and determines timing, active player, Quick Hack overwrite rights, and when effects resolve.

700.1.2. At the start of a turn, the turn player is the active player.

700.1.3. When a card or effect enters the lock, its controller becomes the non-active player; an opponent of that player becomes active. Other players are not in that lock unless a card targets them.

700.1.4. If multiple effects would enter an empty lock simultaneously, the active player puts one of theirs in first; others go to queues.

700.1.5. Only the active player may play a Quick Hack to overwrite the lock during Scenario 2 (see rule 700.3.6).

700.1.6. Paying costs, using resource abilities, and activating into your queue may be done by whoever is currently adding effects (including the non-active player during Alternate); Quick Hack overwrite remains active-player only.

700.2. Scenario 1: Lock occupant, cards, and Quick Hacks

700.2.1. **Empty lock:** A played card or lock-using effect enters the lock.

700.2.2. **Full lock (effects):** A lock-using effect goes to its controller's queue instead. It does not enter the lock.

700.2.3. **Full lock (cards):** A played card overwrites the lock occupant and becomes the new occupant. It does not go to a queue.

700.2.4. **Overwrite result:** When a card overwrites the lock occupant, the replaced card goes to its controller's stockpile with two time counters (or is discarded if stockpile already has two time-counter cards). A replaced effect does nothing. Recalculate active player; restart "while lock is full."

700.2.5. Queued effects never overwrite the lock.

700.3. Scenario 2: Queues

700.3.1. While the lock is full, overflow effects go to queues. The turn does not return to free play until lock and all queues are empty.

700.3.2. **Active batch:** Active player adds legal overflow to their queue, then resolves their entire queue in chosen order.

700.3.3. **Non-active batch:** Non-active player does the same.

700.3.4. **Alternate:** Starting with the active player, each player either adds one queue effect and resolves it, or passes; when both pass in succession, stop.

700.3.5. **Lock occupant resolves:** If lock is still full and any queue is non-empty, repeat 700.3.2–700.3.4. When lock is empty, queues must also be empty before normal play resumes.

700.3.6. A Quick Hack during batches overwrites per Scenario 1; only the active player may do so.

700.4. Time counters

700.4.1. When playing a card, you may place time counters on it to reduce generic pip costs by 1 each (see section 350.4).

700.4.2. If you used time counters when playing the card, skip the lock entirely: put the card revealed in your stockpile with those time counters on it.

700.4.2.1. While the card has one or more time counters on it, it has no abilities (except abilities with the **ATOMIC** tag; see rule 800.1.2). It cannot attack, regardless of zone or ready state.

700.4.3. At the start of each of your turns, remove one counter from each of your time-counter cards.

700.4.4. When the last counter is removed from a stockpile card, resolve its effects without using the lock, in an order of its controller's choosing, then move it to the battlefield (entity) or discard pile (cyberspell). If a unit moves to the battlefield this way, its controller chooses whether it enters readied or expended, and it gains Blitz until the end of the turn (see rule 300.2.2.3).

700.4.5. You may have at most two time-counter cards in stockpile.

700.5. Actions while lock is full

700.5.1. Pay costs and use resource abilities (do not use the lock).

700.5.2. Activate an ability that uses the lock: it goes to your queue.

800. Timing, Triggers, and Keywords

800.1. Tags

800.1.1. Abilities appear as tags except **EFFECT** and activated abilities (see section 800.2). There are two tag types: **static** and **triggered**. A **STATIC** tag is always in effect while the card is in play; any tag that is not static is **triggered** and fires when its printed condition is met.

800.1.2. **ATOMIC** : Active even with time counters on the card.

800.1.3. **ENTERS** : First time entering battlefield or stockpile; always atomic.

800.1.4. **BATTLEFIELD** / **STOCKPILE** : First entry to that zone.

800.1.5. **ATTACK** : When you make an attack with that card.

800.1.6. **START** / **END** : At start or end of your turn.

800.1.7. **INLOCK** : When the card goes to the lock; resolves immediately.

800.1.8. **IF** : **[condition]**, **[effect]** . Triggers when the printed condition is met while this card is in play.

800.1.8.1. If the condition refers to **playing** a card, the condition is met when that play is complete under rule 500.2 (the card enters or overwrites the lock occupant) or rule 700.4.2 (time counters replace the lock step). This includes plays from zones other than hand when an ability allows (see rule 500.2.1), such as Recursive from the discard pile. The triggered effect then enters the lock or its controller's queue like other triggered abilities (see section 700).

800.1.9. **STATIC** : Always active in play.

800.1.10. **EFFECT** : When the played card resolves; default for untagged non-activated abilities.

800.1.11. **DEFEATED** : When the unit is put into the discard pile from play.

800.2. Activated abilities

800.2.1. Format: **[cost]**: **[effect]** . Playable whenever a Quick Hack can be played unless stated otherwise.

800.2.2. If an activated ability targets, it cannot be activated unless at least one legal target exists (see section 100.8).

800.2.3. To activate, pay costs; if the lock is empty the effect enters the lock, otherwise your queue. Declare legal targets when the effect enters the lock or queue.

800.2.4. **Expend** : Turn a card 90° from vertical (readied = vertical).

800.2.5. **Recycle** : Discard from hand at Quick Hack timing.

800.2.6. **Trash** : From battlefield; put printed card in discard pile as cost.

800.2.7. **Dismantle** : From play; put the printed card face up in the dismantle pile as a cost (see rule 200.7).

800.2.8. **Innate abilities**: Abilities on a card that are neither activated abilities nor tags. They follow their rules and do not use the lock unless those rules say otherwise.

800.3. Keyword abilities

800.3. Keyword abilities are not activated abilities. They do not use the **[cost]: [effect]** format, they are not played, and they do not use the lock unless a keyword's rule says otherwise.

800.3.1. *Keywords are static unless noted. Duplicate keywords on one entity do not stack except numerical values, which add.*

800.3.2. **Airborne**: Only Airborne or Long Range can attack this entity. To declare an attack at an objective that has at least one Airborne unit, at least one attacking unit must have Airborne or Long Range (see rule 602.3.1).

800.3.3. **Blitz**: This unit may attack during the turn it entered the battlefield (see rules 300.2.2.1 and 602.2.2).

800.3.4. **Corrosive Bile**: Whenever this entity deals damage to a unit, destroy that unit.

800.3.5. **Degrade X**: Affected player mills X from their deck.

800.3.6. **Durable X**: Defeated at health value + X damage instead of health value.

800.3.7. **Preemptive Strike**: Deals damage first in a fight unless the opponent also has Preemptive Strike (see rule 602.6).

800.3.8. **Hardened X**: Reduce damage taken by X.

800.3.9. **Hard Point**: You may include a second copy of this card in your deck (in addition to the normal copy limit).

800.3.10. **Invulnerable**: Cannot be trashed, dismantled, or destroyed by those effects; cannot be chosen as target for them.

800.3.11. **Lethal X**: Deals X additional damage when it deals damage.

800.3.12. **Long Range**: Can attack Airborne units.

800.3.13. **Recursive**: You may play this card from the discard pile by paying its invoke cost (see rules 500.2 and 500.2.1). Allocate the top card of your deck face down to the played card; the next time this asset would go to the discard pile, dismantle it and the face-down card instead.

800.3.14. **Refurbished**: Dismantle cards from the discard pile to pay  costs on this card.

800.3.15. **Spirit Link**: For every 2 damage this unit deals, heal 1 damage from this unit.

800.3.16. **Stalwart**: Does not expend when attacking.

800.3.17. **Stationary**: Cannot attack.

800.3.18. **Stealth X**: Additional cost to target this entity with a cyberspell or ability, or to declare an attack at an objective that has Stealth. For an attack, pay once for the entire attack force (see rule 602.3.2).

800.3.19. **Sturdy**: Cannot be destroyed by "destroy" effects.

800.3.20. **Surge**: Invokable whenever a Quick Hack can be played.

800.3.21. **Weakened X**: Deals X less damage.

800.3.22. **Desperate Maneuver X**: When you draw this card, you may reveal it. If you do, dismantle X and play it immediately as though it had Surge without paying its invoke cost. Otherwise you may put it into your hand.

800.3.23. **PEER X**: Look at the top X cards of your deck. You may put any of them into your discard pile, then put the rest back on top of your deck in any order.

800.3.24. **Hit'n Run**: After conquering an objective with this unit, you may move this unit off this objective.

800.3.25. **Counter Attack**: This unit deals damage even while it is expended when defending an objective.

900. Deck Building

900.1. A legal deck has at least 40 and at most 100 entity and cyberspell cards, exactly one pilot, and exactly three objective cards. The pilot and objective cards do not count toward the 40-card minimum or the 100-card maximum.

900.2. Deck rules

900.2.1. One pilot only.

900.2.2. At least 40 and at most 100 cards in the deck (entity and cyberspell cards only).

900.2.3. Up to three copies per named card.

900.2.4. Prototype limited to one copy in the deck.

900.2.5. Include any extra cards you want available in the 40-card minimum when building.

900.2.6. Bring exactly three objective cards with your deck. They are not shuffled into the deck. During setup, you place one of them (see rules 250.8 and 400.1.6).

"He forgot to mention HAIs, man...": Svn*